1874

Peking - 9. July

Mr. Wade.

No. 132

Recd Sept 21

Ref: No

Missionary Circular

further on.

For the Queen

& Mr Disraeli

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Peking 223

No. 133

9. July, 1874.

My Lord,

A Japanese Frigate arrived in Shanghai a few days ago from Formosa, having on board an Admiral by name Akamats. Mr. Medhurst privately informs me that he called on him and was told that the three hostile Tribes whom the Japanese went to chastise, had been driven into their own vallies; that the rest

The

Earl of Derby

&c. &c. &c.

rest were well disposed; that a safe anchorage had been found on the east side of Formosa within an easy distance of the Japanese position.- Lastly, he understood the Admiral who, however, spoke English very imperfectly, to say that, if the Chinese came southward with a force, the Japanese would fight.

In a later note Mr. Medhurst

informs

informs me that the Shanghai Arsenal is preparing munitions of war with great activity; that the completion of a Frigate that has been on the stocks for some time past, is being hurried forward; lastly, that a number of Torpedoes have been turned out by Chinese wholly unaided by foreign employés. No cannon or small arms are being made, but the Chinese are buying largely foreign

Rifles

Rifles, even from the Japanese, to send up country, in what direction has not been ascertained.

Admiral Akamats and the Chinese Authorities have exchanged visits, and one interview is said to have been somewhat stormy, the Admiral having asked, peremptorily, what right the Chinese had to send Troops to observe the Japanese in Formosa.

This is a report only, but it consists perfectly with the

Japanese

Japanese contention that that part of the Island they have invaded does not belong to China.

Private letters from Chefoo, up to the 5th Instant, state that a Chinese Gun-Boat arrived on the 3rd from Taiwan with despatches for the Central Government from the High Commissioner Shên. The Commander of the Gun Boat was some years ago a Ship's Comprador (something above a bum-boat man) at Swatow; an

intelligent

intelligent man chosen possibly more for his knowledge of Ships stores and accounts than for other qualities. In reply to a question, he said that none of the Canton Gun Boat Fleet had been detached to Formosa, giving as a reason that the Gun-Boats had all foreigners on board, and that the Chinese wished to do their own business in this matter unaided.

This is mere bravado. The

High

High Commissioner has M. Giquel and M. Segonzac, both officers of the French Navy, with him.

I have the honor to be
with the highest respect,
My Lord,
Your Lordship's most obedient,
Humble servant,
Thomas Francis Wade.

1874
Peking - 9 July
Mr Wade
No 133
Recd Sept 21
Japan and Formosa

For the Queen
Mr Disraeli
Circulate
D

No 134

Peking
9. July, 1874.

My Lord,

The commander of the Chinese Gun-boat mentioned in the foregoing Despatch declares that "the High Commissioner Shên has determined on having an Electric Cable from Taiwan to Foochow."

Mr Medhurst reports officially that M. Dreyer, Director of the Telegraphic Company at Shanghai has been sent for by the Governor General of Fokien and Chehkiang.

The,
Earl of Derby

His